

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 314

By McNally

A RESOLUTION to recognize the K-25 site in Oak Ridge upon its designation as a National Historic Chemical Landmark by the American Chemical Society.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those sites of historical, scientific, and technological significance that have contributed to the advancement of our State and nation; and

WHEREAS, the K-25 site, located in Oak Ridge, was a pivotal facility in the Manhattan Project and played a crucial role in the separation of uranium isotopes using gaseous diffusion technology; and

WHEREAS, the American Chemical Society has officially designated the K-25 site as a National Historic Chemical Landmark, recognizing its groundbreaking contributions to chemistry, engineering, and national security; and

WHEREAS, this designation highlights the scientific and historical importance of the K-25 site and serves to educate future generations about its role in the development of nuclear energy and the broader field of chemistry; and

WHEREAS, the K-25 Gaseous Diffusion Plant was once the world's largest building under one roof and employed thousands of Tennesseans, contributing to the nation's efforts in World War II and the Cold War, while also fostering significant advancements in nuclear science and technology; and

WHEREAS, the technologies pioneered at K-25 laid the foundation for the commercial nuclear energy industry and contributed to U.S. leadership in nonproliferation policy by advancing peaceful applications of nuclear technology and safeguarding materials worldwide; and

WHEREAS, the K-25 History Center and the recently constructed K-25 Viewing Platform and Interpretive Center preserve and interpret the history of the site, showcasing over 250 artifacts and nearly 1,000 oral histories to educate the public on the significance of Oak Ridge's scientific contributions; and

WHEREAS, we take great pride in the rich scientific legacy of Oak Ridge and its continuing contributions to research, technology, and innovation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize the K-25 site in Oak Ridge upon its designation as a National Historic Chemical Landmark by the American Chemical Society and celebrate its lasting contributions to science, technology, and national security.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.